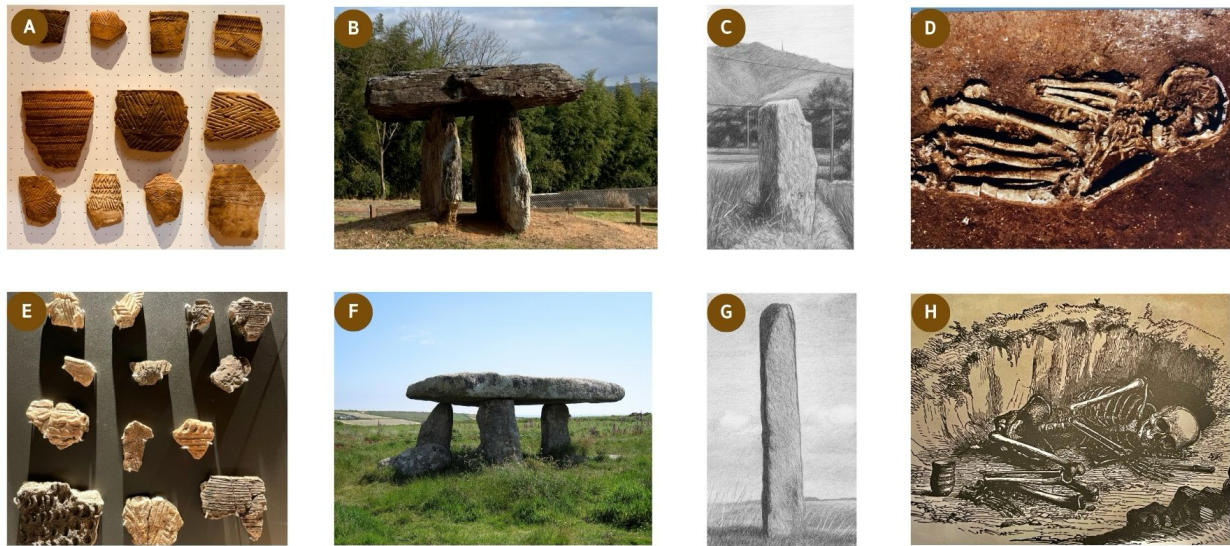


Appendix 4. Visual NMCC Markers on the Korean Peninsula and in the British Isles

Figure 4: NMCC – Comparative Visual Evidence from Korean Peninsula and the British Isles



Note: Figure 4 presents comparative archaeological material from the Korean Peninsula (A–D) and the British Isles (E–H), selected to illustrate three key components of the NMCC: NCPP, NMS, and LBC. Despite the geographical distance, these objects exhibit notable similarities in form and symbolic arrangement.

Figure 4A. Neolithic pottery fragment from Gadeok Island, Busan (Korean Peninsula). Photographed by Byun Dae-Jung at the Gimhae Museum on 15 November 2019. This sherd, excavated from the Gadeok site, features the distinctive linear and dotted incisions characteristic of the NCPP tradition. The deliberate surface decoration reflects symbolic intention and aesthetic conventions widely shared across Neolithic Eurasia. Notably, the fragment was recovered in direct association with a flexed burial (see Figure 4D), underscoring the NMCC’s emphasis on symbolic–spatial co-occurrence and aligning with the LBC marker.

Figure 4B. Dolmen near the Gochang Dolmen Museum, Jeollabuk-do (Korean Peninsula). Photographed by Byun Dae-Jung on 13 January 2020. This dolmen, traditionally attributed to the

Korean Bronze Age in local heritage discourse, exhibits the classic trilithon structure—three upright orthostats supporting a horizontal capstone. Its architectural form closely resembles Dolmen F in Cornwall (British Isles; see Figure 4F), suggesting structural parallels and convergent symbolic logic across distant regions.

Figure 4C. Menhir at Walarm-ri, approximately 10 km from the dolmen shown in Figure 5B (Gochang, Korean Peninsula). This standing stone is located near one of the largest prehistoric shell middens on the peninsula, dated to approximately 6000–4000 BP. The midden, measuring around 150 m in length, 30 m in width, and 3 m in thickness, provides clear evidence of sustained Neolithic occupation. NCPP sherds have been recovered from the site. The image was generated with AI assistance based on field documentation.

Figure 4D. Flexed burial from the Gadeok site, Busan (Korean Peninsula). Photographed by Byun Dae-Jung at the Gimhae Museum on 15 November 2019. This interment displays a tightly contracted posture—known in Korean as *guljang*—with the limbs drawn towards the torso. Seven such burials were unearthed at Gadeok, all oriented north or northeast. This mortuary pattern, previously undocumented on the Korean Peninsula, was found directly alongside NCPP pottery (see Figure 4A). Similar burial configurations have been identified in LBK contexts across Egypt, the Levant, Anatolia, and Europe, pointing to a broader symbolic convergence.

Figure 4E. Grooved Ware pottery (2515–2470 BCE) from Woodhenge, housed at the Wiltshire Museum, Devizes. Photographed by Byun Dae-Jung at the Royal BC Museum, Victoria, Canada, on 22 December 2024. This vessel displays incised motifs—linear and punctate—that resonate aesthetically with the NCPP style seen in Figure 4A. While emerging from distinct cultural traditions, both Grooved Ware and NCPP are frequently found in funerary contexts, reinforcing the NMCC framework’s emphasis on symbolic–mortuary co-occurrence.

Figure 4F. Lanyon Quoit, Cornwall (British Isles; traditionally dated to ca. 3000 BCE). Photograph by Olaf Tausch, licensed under CC BY 3.0. This trilithon-style dolmen—comprising upright orthostats and a horizontal capstone—bears close resemblance to Korean dolmens (see Figure 4B). Despite regional divergence, the structural similarity suggests shared symbolic logic in Neolithic funerary and ritual practices.

Figure 4G. ‘Long Tom’ menhir near Avebury, Wiltshire (British Isles). This standing stone is located within the broader Avebury landscape, an area densely populated with Neolithic monuments. Approximately 1 km to the south lies the Manton Stone Circle, while the Devil’s Den dolmen is located 1.8 km to the west. The image was generated with AI assistance based on spatial data and archaeological documentation.

Figure 4H. Flexed burial from Roundway Down, near Stonehenge (ca. 2450–1850 BCE), associated with the Bell Beaker culture (British Isles). Photographed by Byun Dae-Jung at the Royal BC Museum, Victoria, Canada, on 22 December 2024. The individual was interred in a tightly contracted position, accompanied by grave goods including a bell-shaped beaker, copper pin, flint arrowhead, dagger (likely of Central European origin), and a jade wristguard used for bowstring protection. The posture mirrors the LBC-type burials found on the Korean Peninsula (Figure 4D), while the symbolic ceramic assemblage parallels the aesthetic logic of NCPP traditions (see Figures 4A and 4E), reinforcing the trans-regional patterns defined within the NMCC framework.